RTI Movement

In 1994, thousands of Rajasthani villagers (galvanised by a handful of activists who had tossed away elite careers to live in the impoverished village of Devdungri in Rajsamand district) demanded information (along with bills and vouchers) about public works in their area, including the muster rolls listing worker attendance, wages due, wages paid, materials ordered and materials transported. Expectedly, this demand for an open *hisaab* was fiercely resisted, but the villagers' persistence, and the dedication of their activist friends such as **Aruna Roy**, produced the Freedom of Information Act in 2002 and the Right to Information Act in 2005, magnificent all-India feats launched from a little-known dusty patch in Rajasthan.



BANDEEP SINGH



Farmers' Protest

Enduring Covid, a hard winter, a blistering summer and calumnious propaganda, the victorious 378-day protest staged in 2020-21 on Delhi's borders by India's farmers against the Modi government's farm laws will be remembered for the solidarity offered from one tough month to the next by family members, neighbours and friends—and for the government's climbdown. Led by cultivators from Punjab and Haryana, the protest was backed by farmers across the land who felt the new laws had weakened them against big buyers. On November 19, 2021, Modi said the laws would be repealed; eight days later, they were.